

Take a sled ride

Sit your baby down on a simple plastic sled, or a tin tray or plastic tray, and drag her smoothly across a gentle sand dune, a slightly sloping grassy lawn, or at the park if it has snowed. Show her how to draw shapes in the sand with your fingers or a stick if you are at the beach or in the snow.

Socialize online

Skype or FaceTime a relative or friend regularly while your baby sits on your knee so that other people can begin to bond with her and you can enjoy some support and friendship.

Sensory play

For a calming, sensory playtime activity, stir a few drops of lavender essential oil into a large bowl of dried rice, add a couple of cups and let your baby practice emptying and filling the cups with rice.

Think outside the gender toy box

Your baby is beginning to learn about imaginative play, so now is a good time to refresh the toy box. If you've got a boy you may have been given lots of trains and cars for him to play with, and if you've got a girl, dolls and tea sets maybe. Why not do a toy swap for a while with a friend who has a child of the opposite sex?